Should the family council approve the co-investment opportunity in the Zurich-based fintech proposed by our external advisor?

Format: family-office-memo
Provider: anthropic
Generated at: 2026-11-04T13:12:35.988Z

Recommended option: OPT-A

Aggregated risk: high
Words: 1128 / 1200 target

Robustness: low

Critiques: 7 (critical=1, material=6, minor=0)
Revision needed: yes

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Principal Summary

Defer the Zurich fintech co-investment immediately, committing no capital and granting no approval in principle. The CIO is to state the conditions in writing: full fee disclosure, an explanation of why the allocation is offered, at least four weeks for independent diligence, and licence-linked tranching with tag-along rights. Deferral preserves access without capital at risk, while overall risk is rated high, given an advisor whose pay may depend on completion, compressed diligence and limited minority control over exit. Decline if the lead refuses these conditions or the round closes first.

Context and Heritage Considerations

Preserving patrimony across generations binds this decision: a five-to-seven-year illiquid ticket in an unnamed Zurich fintech must not weaken capital meant to outlast the present council. A minority co-investor almost never holds the right to block or delay an exit, so the hold may run longer than planned. The proposal also arrives through an adviser whose economics may depend on completion. Governance guidance advises against treating such an adviser as the independent check. Practitioner experience adds that poorly executed co-investments can become a graveyard of rushed decisions and concentrated losses. These cautions favour a structured deferral rather than an approval in principle. The council would state its conditions in writing: full fee disclosure, an explanation of why the allocation was offered, at least four weeks for diligence, licence-linked tranching and tag-along rights. If the lead refuses or the round closes, the council declines without regret. The burden of proof rests on the deal, not on declining. No record of prior council decisions was supplied, so alignment with earlier precedent remains to be confirmed.

Sources:

- Co-Investment Rights — Family Office LP Terms — https://valueaddvc.com/blog/co-investment-rights-explained-how-family-offices-negotiate-better-lp-terms
- Family Office Governance: Deciding Fast Enough to Win… — https://www.matchpoint-partners.com/our-insights/family-office-governance-competitive-deals.html
- Co-Investments for Single Family Offices: Benefits, Risks and 5 Practical Approaches — https://www.mercer.com/en-us/insights/investments/alternative-investments/co-investment-opportunities/

Stakeholders and Alignment

At this pre-decision stage, alignment is weak: the External Advisor, Lead Investor and company management are inferred to favour closing, while the council and CIO positions remain undocumented. These stances derive from roles, not public statements, and none is sourced.

- **External Advisor:** Compensation may depend on completion. Governance guidance advises against relying on such an adviser as the independent check.
- **Lead Investor:** Sets terms and exit timing. Co-investors almost never hold a right to block or delay an exit, so the council's influence is limited.
- **CIO and independent diligence providers:** The main counterweight to the advisor-supplied package, under a compressed timetable.
- **FINMA:** Neutral. Its licensing determines what business the target may lawfully run in Switzerland.
- **EU/UK regulators:** Neutral. Swiss firms have no automatic EU passport, so expansion needs a licensed entity or partner.

The burden of proof rests on the deal. The CIO should tell the External Advisor and Lead Investor in writing what the council requires: full fee disclosure, an explanation of why the allocation is offered and which investors declined it, at least four weeks for diligence, licence-linked tranching and tag-along rights. The council should give no approval in principle. If the Lead Investor refuses or the round closes, the council declines. Mitigations remain unconfirmed, so residual risk should not be rated low.

Sources:

- Family Office Governance: Deciding Fast Enough to Win… — https://www.matchpoint-partners.com/our-insights/family-office-governance-competitive-deals.html
- Co-Investment Rights — Family Office LP Terms — https://valueaddvc.com/blog/co-investment-rights-explained-how-family-offices-negotiate-better-lp-terms
- FinTech licence — https://www.finma.ch/en/authorisation/fintech/fintech-bewilligung/
- European Fintech Market 2026: Opportunities for Swiss SMEs — https://www.s-ge.com/export/en/articles/analysis/european-fintech-market-2026-opportunities-swiss-smes

Options and Tradeoffs

Adopt Option B, a structured deferral with no approval in principle, and hold Option A, conditional approval, as the runner-up if the lead accepts the conditions. Decline (Option D) if the lead refuses or the round closes.

Option B: structured deferral. Lowest fiscal exposure now, at the cost of a likely lost allocation. The CIO writes to the advisor and lead. The letter asks for full fee disclosure, a written explanation of why the allocation is offered, at least four weeks for diligence, licence-linked tranching and tag-along rights. No capital is committed. Fiscal exposure is limited to diligence fees. Governance improves because the council is not anchored toward completion and treats the advisor's package as unverified, as [governance guidance](https://www.matchpoint-partners.com/our-insights/family-office-governance-competitive-deals.html) advises. The reputational surface is small. The sources say co-investment windows usually last weeks, so deferral may amount to declining.

Option A: conditional approval. Keeps the allocation, but sunk diligence cost and commitment anchoring follow. Capital is released only after written conditions precedent: advisor disclosure, independent legal, regulatory and financial review, licence evidence, a clean AML review, and a ticket cap within policy limits. Residual risk on advisor bias, compressed diligence and licensing should be read as medium until each mitigation is confirmed in writing. The licence test should model both the current CHF 100 million deposit cap and the proposed payment-institution regime, which could lift the cap but add safeguarding costs. Valuation should be tested against a council-set hurdle on the downside-case return (trade sale at year 7, EU/UK revenue delayed), because no deal-level comparables were found. If the lead refuses these terms, Option A reverts to B or D.

Option C: approve as presented. Fastest, but not recommended. The full ticket is exposed before licence status, AML record, valuation or concentration limits are checked. All nine identified risks are introduced. The decision would be hard to defend to family members if the deal fails. [Mercer](https://www.mercer.com/insights/investments/alternative-investments/co-investment-opportunities/) describes poorly executed co-investments as a "graveyard of rushed decisions and concentrated losses."

No evidence on generational alignment was supplied; the council should test each option against next-generation views before voting.

Sources:

- Family Office Governance: Deciding Fast Enough to Win… — https://www.matchpoint-partners.com/our-insights/family-office-governance-competitive-deals.html
- Co-Investments for Single Family Offices: Benefits, Risks and 5 Practical Approaches — https://www.mercer.com/insights/investments/alternative-investments/co-investment-opportunities/

Risks and Preservation Considerations

Defer approval and decline by default; five risks threaten patrimony, reversible only before capital is paid.

- **Financial, immediate:** An advisor paid on completion may bias the package ([guidance](https://www.matchpoint-partners.com/our-insights/family-office-governance-competitive-deals.html)). Mitigation: signed fee disclosure and a written account of why this allocation was offered; otherwise decline. Residual: medium.
- **Financial, immediate:** Compressed diligence may leave errors in revenue, licence status or terms undetected. Mitigation: four weeks and independent review; refuse less. Residual: medium.
- **Financial, medium-term:** Swiss firms lack an EU passport, so delayed EU/UK revenue may undermine the valuation; likelihood high ([S-GE](https://www.s-ge.com/export/en/articles/analysis/european-fintech-market-2026-opportunities-swiss-smes)). Mitigation: market-access roadmap; approve only if the year-7 trade-sale return, with EU revenue delayed, clears a hurdle set in advance. Residual: medium.
- **Financial, long-term:** A minority co-investor cannot block the lead's exit ([terms](https://valueaddvc.com/blog/co-investment-rights-explained-how-family-offices-negotiate-better-lp-terms)). Mitigation: tag-along rights, written exit analysis, no IPO assumption. Residual: medium.
- **Reputational, immediate:** Approving an unverified package, or an AML or licence failure at the target, would be hard to defend. Mitigation: licence evidence and clean AML review as conditions precedent.

Sources:

- Family Office Governance: Deciding Fast Enough to Win… — https://www.matchpoint-partners.com/our-insights/family-office-governance-competitive-deals.html
- European Fintech Market 2026: Opportunities for Swiss SMEs — https://www.s-ge.com/export/en/articles/analysis/european-fintech-market-2026-opportunities-swiss-smes
- Co-Investment Rights — Family Office LP Terms — https://valueaddvc.com/blog/co-investment-rights-explained-how-family-offices-negotiate-better-lp-terms

Recommended Next Step

Instruct the CIO immediately to send the advisor and lead investor written notice that the council defers any approval, with no approval in principle, until they provide full fee disclosure, a written explanation of why the allocation is offered, four weeks for independent diligence, and licence-linked tranching with tag-along rights, and decline the co-investment if the lead refuses or the round closes first.

Requester-provided, not sourceable

The facts below concern only the requester. No public source can establish them, so this briefing counts none of them as sourced; the requester supplies them, and every statement that rests on them is as reliable as that information.

- The proposed investment amount, instrument and term sheet details as presented by the advisor
- The family's investment policy statement, target allocation to private/venture investments and current exposure to fintech
- The family's liquidity needs and acceptable holding period for illiquid assets
- The external advisor's fee arrangement, any carry or placement compensation, and history of prior recommendations
- The family council's decision criteria, approval thresholds and risk tolerance
- Any prior relationship between the family and the company, its founders or the lead investor
- Any family values, ESG or reputational constraints relevant to fintech investments

Insufficiently sourced

This format's sourcing policy is strict. The 39 item(s) below did not meet it.
They stayed in the analysis that produced this briefing; treat every statement
that rests on them as unverified.

- **research item 2**: https://fintechwerkstatt.ch/swiss-fintech-licence-finma-approval/swiss-fintech-licence-requirements/ is not a trusted domain (host 'fintechwerkstatt.ch' matches no reputation tier).
- **research item 3**: https://fintech.global/2026/09/21/european-fintech-funding-projected-to-increase-18-in-2026-as-deals-under-100m-grow-in-h1/ is not a trusted domain (host 'fintech.global' matches no reputation tier).
- **research item 4**: https://blogs.lse.ac.uk/businessreview/2026/07/06/europes-startup-boom-still-needs-an-exit-plan/ is not a trusted domain (host 'blogs.lse.ac.uk' matches no reputation tier).
- **research item 5**: https://valueaddvc.com/blog/co-investment-rights-explained-how-family-offices-negotiate-better-lp-terms is not a trusted domain (host 'valueaddvc.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **research item 6**: https://www.matchpoint-partners.com/our-insights/family-office-governance-competitive-deals.html is not a trusted domain (host 'www.matchpoint-partners.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **Research finding 7** — “No source found establishes whether the proposed valuation and terms of the Zurich fintech co-investment are in line with comparable European or Swiss fintech rounds.”: no source found (searched for: Valuation multiples and comparable round terms for Swiss/European fintech co-investments in 2026, and Swiss VC H1 2026 fintech investment figures).
- **Stakeholder Family council**: position not sourced (searched for: Public statements on this council's stance. It is a private body, and the council's criteria and thresholds are requester-provided and not public.).
- **Stakeholder Family office investment team / CIO**: position not sourced (searched for: Any documented view of the family office staff on this co-investment. Scoping gives no public statement, and the internal view is requester-provided.).
- **Stakeholder External advisor (deal presenter)**: position not sourced (searched for: Public statements, filings or coverage on this advisor's recommendation and fee arrangement. The advisor is unnamed; the supportive stance is inferred from the scoping fact that it presented the deal, not from a public source.).
- **Stakeholder Lead investor / sponsor**: position not sourced (searched for: The lead investor's identity and public statements on the round. The lead is unidentified in the scoping and research output; the supportive stance is inferred from its role in leading the round.).
- **Stakeholder Company management / founders**: position not sourced (searched for: Statements or coverage from the target's management. The company is not identified in the scoping or research output; the supportive stance is inferred from their raising capital.).
- **stakeholder item 7**: https://practiceguides.chambers.com/practice-guides/banking-regulation-2026/switzerland/trends-and-developments is not a trusted domain (host 'practiceguides.chambers.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **stakeholder item 8**: https://www.s-ge.com/export/en/articles/analysis/european-fintech-market-2026-opportunities-swiss-smes is not a trusted domain (host 'www.s-ge.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **Stakeholder Independent diligence providers (legal, financial, regulatory counsel)**: position not sourced (searched for: Any engaged provider's public position. None has been identified or

engaged per the scoping; this is a recommended stakeholder class, not a known actor.).
- **risk item 1**: https://www.matchpoint-partners.com/our-insights/family-office-governance-competitive-deals.html is not a trusted domain (host 'www.matchpoint-partners.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **Risk RISK-001** (impact evidence): not sourced (searched for: Quantified loss precedents where a family office relied on a completion-incentivised adviser's recommendation for a co-investment. Searches found governance guidance but no loss data.).
- **risk item 3**: https://valueaddvc.com/blog/co-investment-rights-explained-how-family-offices-negotiate-better-lp-terms is not a trusted domain (host 'valueaddvc.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **risk item 4**: https://www.mercer.com/en-us/insights/investments/alternative-investments/co-investment-opportunities/ is not a trusted domain (host 'www.mercer.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **risk item 5**: https://business-in-switzerland.com/specialised/finma-license/ is not a trusted domain (host 'business-in-switzerland.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **risk item 6**: https://goldblum.ch/financial-regulation/banking-fintech-licence/ is not a trusted domain (host 'goldblum.ch' matches no reputation tier).
- **risk item 7**: https://www.rpcs.ch/blog/finma-supervision-payment-crypto-institutions is not a trusted domain (host 'www.rpcs.ch' matches no reputation tier).
- **risk item 8**: https://www.deloitte.com/ch/en/Industries/financial-services/blogs/regulatory-update-new-rules-payment-tokens.html is not a trusted domain (host 'www.deloitte.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **risk item 9**: https://www.s-ge.com/export/en/articles/analysis/european-fintech-market-2026-opportunities-swiss-smes is not a trusted domain (host 'www.s-ge.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **risk item 10**: https://www.legal500.com/intelligence/switzerland/technology/navigating-fintech-regulation-in-europe-a-strategic-guide-for-cross-border-compliance is not a trusted domain (host 'www.legal500.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **risk item 11**: https://www.legal500.com/intelligence/switzerland/government-public-sector/finma-tightens-aml-and-sanctions-enforcement is not a trusted domain (host 'www.legal500.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **risk item 12**: https://www.mofo.com/resources/insights/260421-the-anti-money-laundering-quarterly is not a trusted domain (host 'www.mofo.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **risk item 13**: https://www.privatemarketsinsights.com/post/europe-s-seed-rounds-got-bigger-and-cheaper-its-series-c-quadrupled is not a trusted domain (host 'www.privatemarketsinsights.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **risk item 14**: https://www.contextualsolutions.de/blog/european-fintech-fundraising-vc-trends-2025-2026 is not a trusted domain (host 'www.contextualsolutions.de' matches no reputation tier).
- **Risk RISK-008** (likelihood evidence): not sourced (searched for: The family's ticket size, private-markets allocation and liquidity limits. These are requester-provided and not public, so the probability of a breach cannot be sourced.).
- **risk item 16**: https://markrgraham.com/how-family-offices-use-alternative-assets-to-protect-wealth/ is not a trusted domain (host 'markrgraham.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **risk item 17**: https://www.privatemarketsinsights.com/post/european-vc-valuations-re-rate-higher-as-down-rounds-recede is not a trusted domain (host 'www.privatemarketsinsights.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **risk item 18**: https://state-of-fintech-2026.teampcn.com/ is not a trusted domain (host 'state-of-fintech-2026.teampcn.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **Research finding 35**: no source found (searched for: [CRIT-001] Not applicable to an

external source: this contradiction is inside the brief, between the principal-summary wording and the OPT-A summary and tradeoffs (time-to-close of at least 4 weeks plus about 3 weeks of review).).
- **Research finding 39**: no source found (searched for: [CRIT-005] Not run as an external search: the challenge is to the brief's own residual ratings, set against its admissions in the OPT-A tradeoffs and the options' unresolved uncertainties.).
- **Research finding 40**: no source found (searched for: [CRIT-006] Not re-run: the research agent's own search for Swiss/European fintech round comparables and valuation multiples for 2026 returned no deal-level data (finding 6).).
- **Research finding 41**: no source found (searched for: [CRIT-007] Not applicable to an external source: the omission is shown by the risks-and-preservation validation_issues compared with risks.top_3_priorities.).
- **Option OPT-B**: https://www.mercer.com/insights/investments/alternative-investments/co-investment-opportunities/ is not a trusted domain (host 'www.mercer.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **Option OPT-C**: https://www.campdenwealth.com/sites/default/files/GFO_EU_2022_D.pdf is not a trusted domain (host 'www.campdenwealth.com' matches no reputation tier).
- **Option OPT-D**: https://www.institutionalinvestor.com/article/family-offices-struggle-find-direct-deals-we-werent-getting-paid-time-we-were-investing is not a trusted domain (host 'www.institutionalinvestor.com' matches no reputation tier).

Options

ID	Title	Recommendation	Time horizon
OPT-A	Conditional approval with a capped, two-tranche ticket	recommended	short-term
OPT-B	Defer the decision until independent diligence is complete	acceptable	immediate
OPT-C	Approve the ticket as presented by the advisor	not-recommended	immediate
OPT-D	Decline the co-investment	acceptable	immediate

Risks

ID	Category	Likelihood	Impact	Timeframe
RISK-001	strategic	medium	major	immediate
RISK-002	operational	high	major	immediate
RISK-003	regulatory	medium	major	short-term
RISK-004	regulatory	medium	moderate	medium-term
RISK-005	regulatory	high	major	medium-term
RISK-006	operational	low	major	short-term
RISK-007	strategic	high	major	long-term
RISK-008	financial	medium	major	short-term
RISK-009	financial	medium	moderate	medium-term

Stakeholders

Name	Position	Power	Priority
Family council	unknown	high	critical
Family office investment team / CIO	unknown	high	critical
External advisor (deal presenter)	supportive	high	critical
Lead investor / sponsor	supportive	high	critical
Company management / founders	supportive	medium	important
FINMA (Swiss Financial Market Supervisory Authority)	neutral	high	critical
Swiss federal authorities reviewing the FinTech (Art. 1b) licence (EFD, SIF / Federal Council)	neutral	medium	important
EU/UK financial regulators and licensed independent diligence providers (legal, financial, regulatory counsel)	neutral	medium	important

Adversarial Critique

Robustness: low
Critiques: 7 (critical=1, material=6, minor=0)
Revision needed: yes

Steelmanned alternative:
Adopt OPT-B as a structured deferral, with no 'approval in principle'. The CIO tells the advisor and lead in writing which conditions the family needs: full fee disclosure, an explanation of why the allocation is being offered, at least 4 weeks to diligence, licence-linked tranching and tag-along rights. If the lead refuses or the round closes, the family declines (OPT-D) without regret. This keeps all of OPT-A's protections, avoids anchoring the council toward completion, and treats an advisor-sourced minority ticket as no-by-default unless verified evidence overturns that.

CRIT-001 — internal-contradiction (material)

Steelmanned position:
The headline opens with 'Approve the Zurich fintech co-investment immediately', but OPT-A releases no capital until several conditions precedent are met, and those conditions need at least seven weeks. A council member who reads only the first line could take this as a mandate to commit now. That would recreate the rushed decision the brief warns against. 'Approve immediately' and 'release nothing until verified' are opposite instructions, and the most-read sentence picks the wrong one.

Implication if true:
Approval could be read as an unconditional commitment, or as the start of one. The deal would then drift toward OPT-C in practice.

Suggested revision:
Replace 'Approve ... immediately' with 'Authorise conditional negotiation now; commit capital only after all written conditions precedent are verified by the CIO'.

Counter-evidence:
SOURCE_MISSING — searched for: Not applicable to an external source: this contradiction is inside the brief, between the principal-summary wording and the OPT-A summary and tradeoffs (time-to-close of at least 4 weeks plus about 3 weeks of review).

CRIT-002 — hidden-assumption (critical)

Steelmanned position:
The case for OPT-A over OPT-B rests on one assumption: that a capped minority ticket gives the family leverage to win a longer timetable, licence-linked tranching, tag-along rights and a written exit analysis. The brief's own research (finding 4) says the opposite. Co-investors usually get 2–4 weeks and rely on the lead's underwriting, and the brief offers no evidence that the lead will agree to any of these terms. If the lead refuses, OPT-A becomes OPT-B or OPT-D anyway. The one thing that would really differ is an 'approval in principle' vote. That vote anchors the council toward completing the deal and hands the advisor a signal of commitment, with no extra protection to show for it.

Implication if true:
OPT-A has no real advantage over a structured deferral, and it adds the cost of anchoring. The recommendation should then be a deferral that sets out its conditions, with decline as the default if the lead refuses.

Suggested revision:
Before recommending OPT-A, the CIO should get the lead's written answer on the timetable, tranching and tag-along rights, and the brief should recommend OPT-B with an automatic decline if the lead refuses.

Counter-evidence:
Co-Investment: Definition, Examples & How It Works — https://pipelineroad.com/glossary/co-investment

CRIT-003 — temporal-blind-spot (material)

Steelmanned position:
The brief treats the CHF 100m deposit cap as a lasting ceiling on the business model. It appears in finding 0, in the stakeholder dynamics, in OPT-A's supporting evidence and in the options section. But the FinIA reform, whose consultation closed in February 2026, would abolish the FinTech licence and remove the cap. Within a 5–7 year hold, the regulatory picture is therefore likely to change in both directions. The cap may disappear, which helps the target. New duties to segregate client funds and a possible extra licence for foreign-controlled firms could push costs up. The brief frames the reform only as a moderate downside.

Implication if true:
Using the CHF 100m cap to test 'licence fit' could reject a viable model or mis-price the regulatory upside. The cost of transition and of a foreign-control licence may also be underestimated.

Suggested revision:
Rewrite the licence condition and RISK-004 so they model both the current Art. 1b regime and the proposed payment-institution regime, including the cap removal and any foreign-control licence requirement.

Counter-evidence:
FinIA reform: new licences for payment and crypto-institutions — https://www.loyensloeff.com/insights/news--events/news/swiss-federal-council-proposes-finia-amendments-new-licences-for-payment-and-crypto-institutions-to-replace-fintech-regime/

CRIT-004 — missing-perspective (material)

Steelmanned position:
The brief never asks why this allocation reached the family at all. When a deal comes through an external advisor rather than an established relationship with a lead investor, the family may be seeing deals that better-placed investors passed on: a classic lemons problem. OPT-D is rejected on the grounds that the company 'has not been checked'. But for an unsolicited deal from an advisor whose pay depends on completion, the starting expectation should be below average quality. The burden of proof belongs on the deal, not on declining it.

Implication if true:
Declining is a reasonable default for advisor-sourced co-investments, not a costly loss of option value. That weakens the dismissal of OPT-D. Note that Braun, Jenkinson and Schemmerl (2020) found no adverse selection in a larger GP-sourced sample, so the evidence is mixed.

Suggested revision:
Add a condition requiring the advisor and lead to explain in writing why the allocation is being offered, which other investors were approached or declined, and the lead's own ticket size relative to its fund.

Counter-evidence:
The Disintermediation of Financial Markets: Direct Investing in Private Equity — https://

www.researchgate.net/publication/254931542_The_Disintermediation_of_Financial_Markets_Direct_Investing_in_Private_Equity

CRIT-005 — risk-underestimated (material)

Steelmanned position:
The brief rates residual risk 'low' for RISK-001, RISK-002 and RISK-003. Those mitigations depend on a three-week review of an unidentified company, on fee deferral that is only 'negotiated' and falls back to simply recording the fee, and on terms the lead has not accepted. A three-week review is the same compressed diligence the brief criticises. OPT-A also lists no risks it introduces, although its own tradeoffs admit sunk diligence costs, friction with the lead and a possible collapse into OPT-B or OPT-D. Calling the residual risk 'low' gives the council false comfort.

Implication if true:
The worst case is not as 'known before the vote' as the brief claims. The council would be approving with more residual risk than it has been shown.

Suggested revision:
Raise residual risk for RISK-001 to RISK-003 to medium unless each mitigation is confirmed in writing, and list sunk diligence cost and commitment anchoring as risks introduced by OPT-A.

Counter-evidence:
SOURCE_MISSING — searched for: Not run as an external search: the challenge is to the brief's own residual ratings, set against its admissions in the OPT-A tradeoffs and the options' unresolved uncertainties.

CRIT-006 — overconfidence (material)

Steelmanned position:
One condition precedent requires the entry valuation to sit within the interquartile range of at least five comparable 2025–26 European fintech rounds. Yet finding 6 found no deal-level comparables. Venture rounds differ widely by stage, instrument, liquidation preferences and business model, so a set of five could be picked to justify almost any price. The condition sounds rigorous, but it may be impossible to meet honestly or easy to game. Either way it gives false precision about whether the price is fair.

Implication if true:
The valuation check might not protect the family against overpaying, which leaves RISK-009 largely unmitigated.

Suggested revision:
Replace the IQR test with a returns-based test: approve only if the family's downside-case return (trade sale at year 7, EU revenue delayed) clears a hurdle set by the council in advance, whatever the comparables show.

Counter-evidence:
SOURCE_MISSING — searched for: Not re-run: the research agent's own search for Swiss/European fintech round comparables and valuation multiples for 2026 returned no deal-level data (finding 6).

CRIT-007 — internal-contradiction (material)

Steelmanned position:
RISK-005, the lack of an EU passport, is one of the brief's three top-priority risks, carries high likelihood and stays at medium residual risk after mitigation. Yet the risks section the council will read leaves it out, along with licence fit and valuation, to save words. The council is therefore

shown a lower-risk picture than the analysis supports. And the growth case that justifies the valuation depends on exactly this missing risk.

Implication if true:
The council could approve without considering the risk most closely tied to the valuation thesis.

Suggested revision:
Restore RISK-005 to the risks-and-preservation section, with its high likelihood and medium residual rating, by cutting lower-priority text elsewhere.

Counter-evidence:
SOURCE_MISSING — searched for: Not applicable to an external source: the omission is shown by the risks-and-preservation validation_issues compared with risks.top_3_priorities.

Appendix A — Findings

Finding 1

Claim:
A Swiss FINMA FinTech licence (Banking Act Art. 1b) is a restricted authorisation: it caps public deposits at CHF 100 million, which cannot be invested or interest-bearing, and client assets get no deposit protection if the institution fails.

Evidence:
FINMA's licence page says the FinTech licence permits public deposits of up to CHF 100 million or crypto-based assets, provided they are not invested and pay no interest. The licence holder must be a Swiss company with its registered office and business activities in Switzerland. The council should confirm which licence, if any, the target holds or needs, because the licence caps the business model.

Source:
FinTech licence — https://www.finma.ch/en/authorisation/fintech/fintech-bewilligung/

Finding 2

Claim:
Practitioner guidance says the FinTech licence requires at least CHF 300,000 in capital, AML/KYC controls under direct FINMA supervision, and in practice one board member and two executive managers resident in Switzerland.

Evidence:
A licensing-advisory site summarises the Art. 1b requirements as CHF 300k capital, a Swiss AG or GmbH with real activity in Switzerland, a regulatory audit firm and ongoing FINMA reporting. This source is a commercial adviser, not the regulator, and it is not on the accepted-host list. Treat the figures as indicative until checked against FINMA or the Banking Ordinance.

Source:
Swiss FinTech Licence Requirements — https://fintechwerkstatt.ch/swiss-fintech-licence-finma-approval/swiss-fintech-licence-requirements/

Finding 3

Claim:
European fintech funding in H1 2026 was $9.2bn across 386 deals, tracking modestly ahead of 2025, when it was $15.5bn across 742 deals.

Evidence:
Fintech.global reports H1 2026 at 59% of 2025's funding and 52% of its deal volume. Deals under $100m raised $3.8bn, up 11% year on year. A separate Q3 2026 summary (evotek.vn, which cites fintech.global data) puts Q3 at about $2.4bn across 172 deals, with sub-$100m deals 11% lower year on year. Use this as market context for valuation benchmarking, not as a comparable for the target. The source is a trade site, not an accepted host.

Source:
European FinTech funding projected to increase 18% in 2026 as deals under $100m grow in H1 — https://fintech.global/2026/09/21/european-fintech-funding-projected-to-increase-18-in-2026-as-deals-under-100m-grow-in-h1/

Finding 4

Claim:
The European fintech exit environment is contested: commentary points to strategic sales

rather than IPOs as the realistic route for mid-tier fintechs, and the LSE Business Review argues European exit markets still need to deepen.

Evidence:
The LSE Business Review (6 July 2026) says that without deeper IPO markets and more active corporate buyers, Europe may finance more scale-ups while their eventual value is realised abroad. A trade commentary (contextualsolutions.de) says mid-tier fintechs are now likely to exit by strategic sale rather than IPO. Both support a base case of M&A or a secondary sale, not an IPO, for the 5–7 year hold. Neither source is on the accepted-host list.

Source:
Europe’s startup boom still needs an exit plan - LSE Business Review — https://blogs.lse.ac.uk/businessreview/2026/07/06/europes-startup-boom-still-needs-an-exit-plan/

Finding 5

Claim:
Co-investing alongside a lead typically concentrates risk, compresses diligence to about 2–4 weeks, and gives the minority co-investor little or no contractual control over exit timing.

Evidence:
A family-office LP-terms guide says a single co-investment can carry 5–10x the exposure of a typical fund-level position in one company. It says decisions often rely heavily on the GP's own underwriting, and co-investors almost never hold a right to block or delay an exit. The source is a practitioner blog, not an accepted host, and it describes GP/LP co-invest rather than this specific deal.

Source:
Co-Investment Rights — Family Office LP Terms — https://valueaddvc.com/blog/co-investment-rights-explained-how-family-offices-negotiate-better-lp-terms

Finding 6

Claim:
Governance guidance for family offices says an adviser whose economics depend on deal completion should not be relied on as the independent diligence check without safeguards.

Evidence:
A family-office governance paper recommends a standing interest register, transaction-specific conflict confirmations, and a deal record that separates verified facts, adviser conclusions, management estimates and assumptions. Adviser remuneration and referral fees are listed among typical conflict sources. This supports requiring disclosure of the advisor's placement fee or carry and commissioning independent diligence. The source is a consultancy publication, not an accepted host.

Source:
Family Office Governance: Deciding Fast Enough to Win… — https://www.matchpoint-partners.com/our-insights/family-office-governance-competitive-deals.html

Finding 7

Claim:
No source found establishes whether the proposed valuation and terms of the Zurich fintech co-investment are in line with comparable European or Swiss fintech rounds.

Evidence:
The company, term sheet and valuation were not identified in the scoping output. Searches returned only aggregate European funding data and event listings for Zurich, with no deal-level comparables. The Swiss Venture Capital Report (Startupticker) mentions an H1 2026

investment update, but the result showed no figures.

Source:
SOURCE_MISSING — searched for: Valuation multiples and comparable round terms for Swiss/European fintech co-investments in 2026, and Swiss VC H1 2026 fintech investment figures

Appendix B — Stakeholders

Name	Category	Position	Power	Priority
Family council	decision-maker	unknown	high	critical
Family office investment team / CIO	gatekeeper	unknown	high	critical
External advisor (deal presenter)	influencer	supportive	high	critical
Lead investor / sponsor	gatekeeper	supportive	high	critical
Company management / founders	influencer	supportive	medium	important
FINMA (Swiss Financial Market Supervisory Authority)	gatekeeper	neutral	high	critical
Swiss federal authorities reviewing the application	external-observer	neutral	medium	important
FinTech (Art. 1b) licensed asset manager	gatekeeper	neutral	medium	important
Independent advisors (SIF / Federal Council)	influencer	neutral	medium	important
EU/UK financial services providers (legal, financial, regulatory counsel)	influencer	neutral	medium	important

Appendix C — Risk Register

ID	Category	Likelihood	Impact	Timeframe
RISK-001	strategic	medium	major	immediate
RISK-002	operational	high	major	immediate
RISK-003	regulatory	medium	major	short-term
RISK-004	regulatory	medium	moderate	medium-term
RISK-005	regulatory	high	major	medium-term
RISK-006	operational	low	major	short-term
RISK-007	strategic	high	major	long-term
RISK-008	financial	medium	major	short-term
RISK-009	financial	medium	moderate	medium-term

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Sourcing Report

Policy: strict
Total items: 41
OK: 4 · stale: 0 · untrusted: 23 · duplicated: 1 · missing: 13
Freshness unknown (no publication date): 24
Requester-provided, not sourceable: 7

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- [stakeholder] 'External advisor (deal presenter)' SOURCE_MISSING — Public statements, filings or coverage on this advisor's recommendation and fee arrangement. The advisor is unnamed; the supportive stance is inferred from the scoping fact that it presented the deal, not from a public source.
- [stakeholder] 'Lead investor / sponsor' SOURCE_MISSING — The lead investor's identity and public statements on the round. The lead is unidentified in the scoping and research output; the supportive stance is inferred from its role in leading the round.
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- [research] finding[38] SOURCE_MISSING — [CRIT-005] Not run as an external search: the challenge is to the brief's own residual ratings, set against its admissions in the OPT-A tradeoffs and the options' unresolved uncertainties.
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